

Assistant Manager (Technical) — WMC Interview Prep Guide

Ahtesham Asif | Institute of Allied Health Sciences, Wah Medical College

1. Know the Institution (they will ask "what do you know about us?")

- **Wah Medical College (WMC)** was established in **2003** by the **Pakistan Ordnance Factories (POF) Board / POF Welfare Trust**. It's a **private institution but run with a defense/semi-government (POF) management culture** — expect formal hierarchy, discipline, and respect for protocol, similar to a government office interview.
- WMC runs a **5-year MBBS program**, and also has an **Institute of Nursing** and the **Institute of Allied Health Sciences (IAHS)** — the institute you're applying to.
- Principal: **Maj Gen (R) Abdul Khaliq Naveed**. Teaching hospital: **POF Hospital, Wah Cantt.**
- Affiliated with **Pakistan Medical and Dental Council (PMC/PMDC)**, **University of Health Sciences Lahore**, and **National University of Medical Sciences (NUMS)**.
- Say something like: *"WMC is a POF-run institution known for disciplined academic culture and strong healthcare training — I'd be proud to bring reliable, well-documented technical systems to an institute serving future healthcare professionals."*

Because of the POF/defense-linked culture, treat this like a **semi-government interview**:

- Address the panel as "Sir" / "Respected Panel"
 - Don't interrupt; wait to be asked to sit
 - Be humble about being a fresh graduate but confident about your practical work
 - Punctuality is critical — arrive 20–30 minutes early
 - Carry **printed copies** of your CV, application letter (the one you already wrote), CNIC copy, degree/transcript, and photos — exactly as you listed in your cover letter
-

2. Understand the Role (Assistant Manager - Technical, not "Software Developer")

This is a **management/technical hybrid role**, not a pure coding job. In an academic institute this usually covers:

- Maintaining computer labs, networks, and campus IT infrastructure
- Managing/supporting any student portal, ERP, exam software, or website

- Coordinating with vendors (hardware, internet/ISP, printers, biometric systems)
- Basic software development/customization for internal tools
- Data management, backups, and system security
- Supervising junior IT staff or lab assistants
- Documentation and reporting to the Principal's office

Reframe your CV language in your head: you're not just a "Full Stack Developer" — you're someone who can **own a technical system end-to-end**: build it, deploy it, secure it, document it, and support the people using it. That maps perfectly onto this job.

3. "Tell Me About Yourself" — Ready Answer

"I'm Ahtesham Asif, a recent BS Software Engineering graduate from COMSATS University Islamabad, Wah Campus. Over the last year and a half, alongside my studies, I've worked as a project-based Full Stack Developer and completed two internships — one at the National Incubation Center Islamabad, where I built a web platform for an environmental organization, and one at Being Optimizer, where I managed CMS-based websites for clients. I've built end-to-end systems — from database design to cloud deployment — using tools like Laravel, Next.js, MySQL, and AWS. I'm from Wah Cantt myself, so joining WMC feels like a chance to bring my technical skills back to my own community, in a role that combines hands-on technical work with management responsibility."

Keep it under 60–90 seconds. Don't recite your whole CV — this is the hook.

4. Walking Through Your CV — Talking Points for Each Project

For each, be ready to explain in **30–45 seconds**: what it does, what YOU built, what tech, and one challenge you solved. Use this pattern: **Problem → What I built → Tech → Outcome/Learning**.

Project	1-line pitch you can say out loud
EPO Environmental System (NIC internship)	"I helped build a platform for an environmental organization with carbon-credit tracking and e-commerce, deployed on AWS EC2 with Docker — my first real experience with production deployment."
Dr. Neuro App & Website	"A medical appointment system with a Flutter app, Laravel backend, and WhatsApp notifications via Twilio — closest project to healthcare IT, worth highlighting here since WMC is a medical institute."
Premium Food Ordering System	"A full order-management platform with real-time workflow and payments using Next.js and TypeScript — shows I can handle transactional, real-time systems."
Cinderela Charmora / Gamisha / Cars Selling Platform	"E-commerce platforms — good for showing UI/UX and database design skills, mention briefly, don't dwell."
Healthcare Deployment System	"Set up CI/CD pipelines and cloud infrastructure with Docker, Nginx, AWS for healthcare apps — directly relevant to keeping IT systems reliable, which is core to this role."
Software Testing Project	"Manual and automated testing with Selenium/Playwright and JIRA — shows I understand quality assurance, not just building things fast."
AI Agent Bot (JARVIS style)	"A personal project automating PC tasks with Python — good if they ask about self-driven learning/initiative."

Tip: Since the panel is likely non-technical (Principal, HR, maybe one IT person), explain projects in **plain outcomes**, not jargon. Say "I built a system that let users book appointments and get automatic WhatsApp reminders" rather than "I integrated Twilio API with a Laravel REST backend."

5. Likely General/HR Questions + Suggested Answers

Q: You're a fresh graduate — why should we give you a management position?

"I understand this is an entry point, not a senior management role. But over the past 1.5 years I've already worked in real environments — client projects, an internship building production systems, and a CMS-management internship — so I've had exposure to ownership, deadlines, and coordinating with non-technical stakeholders. I'm confident I can grow quickly into the supervisory parts of the role."

Q: Why do you want to work at WMC / in Wah Cantt (instead of moving to Islamabad for a higher-paying dev job)?

Be honest and positive — mention stability, being close to family/community, and interest in contributing to an institution that serves healthcare education. Avoid saying "because I couldn't find another job."

Q: What are your salary expectations?

For a fresh-graduate assistant manager (technical) role in a semi-government-style Pakistani institute, expect a range roughly **PKR 40,000-70,000/month** depending on the institute's scale — but don't lead with numbers. Say: *"I'd like to understand the full responsibilities and WMC's standard pay scale for this grade, and I'm confident we can agree on something fair."* Never state a number first if you can avoid it.

Q: What are your strengths/weaknesses?

- Strengths: fast learner, hands-on across the full stack (dev to deployment), used to working directly with clients/non-technical people.
- Weakness: pick something real and show you're managing it — e.g., "I sometimes take on too many project details myself instead of delegating — I'm working on documenting things clearly so others can pick them up."

Q: Are you willing to handle hardware/network issues, not just software?

Say yes confidently — mention your DevOps/Linux/networking coursework and AWS/Docker/server experience as proof you're comfortable outside pure app development.

Q: This is a full-time office job with fixed timing — are you okay with that (not freelancing)?

Be clear you can commit fully; if you're currently doing freelance/project-based work, say you'll wind that down for a full-time commitment.

6. Likely Technical Questions (broad, since role = "Technical" management)

Be ready for a **mix of basic-to-intermediate** questions — they're testing breadth, not depth of one framework, since the role oversees systems generally.

Web & Databases

- Difference between SQL and NoSQL — you know MySQL/PostgreSQL, mention normalization briefly.

- What is an API / REST API — explain simply: "a way for two systems to talk to each other over HTTP!"
- Frontend vs backend — you can explain this clearly given your stack breadth.
- What is a CMS — you managed one at Being Optimizer, use that example.

Networking / IT Infrastructure basics

- What is a LAN vs WAN, IP address, DNS, DHCP — review basics (see Section 8 for a quick refresher).
- What's a firewall, and why does an institute need one.
- How do you take backups / ensure data isn't lost — talk about scheduled backups, cloud storage, version control (Git).

Cloud/DevOps (this is a real strength on your CV — lean into it)

- What is Docker and why use it — "packages an app with everything it needs so it runs the same everywhere."
- What is CI/CD — automated pipeline to test and deploy code safely.
- AWS EC2 basics — you have hands-on experience, describe it simply.

Security

- How do you secure a web application (basic answers: HTTPS, input validation, authentication, regular updates).
- What would you do if the college website got hacked or went down — give a calm, structured answer (isolate, diagnose, restore from backup, patch, report).

Project/People management (since it's "Assistant Manager")

- How would you handle a situation where a vendor delivers late or a system fails during exams — show calm, structured problem-solving, escalate appropriately, always keep the Principal's office informed.

7. The .NET Angle — What Your Senior Told You

Your senior's insight (WMC may want someone with **.NET** experience) is valuable — most Pakistani institutional/ERP software (attendance systems, exam software, HMIS) is still commonly built in **ASP.NET / C#** because of legacy enterprise tooling. You don't need to become a .NET expert in two days — you need **enough to speak intelligently and show initiative**.

"My strongest hands-on experience is in Laravel and the JavaScript/Next.js ecosystem, but the concepts are the same — MVC architecture, REST APIs, ORMs, and relational databases. I've started exploring ASP.NET Core because I understand it's widely used for institutional systems, and I'm confident I can get productive in it quickly given my background."

This is honest, confident, and shows initiative — much stronger than pretending to be a .NET expert.

Quick .NET Orientation (read this once, you'll retain enough to talk about it)

- **.NET** is Microsoft's development platform. **C#** is the main language.
- **ASP.NET Core** = the modern framework for building web apps/APIs (similar role to Laravel in PHP, or Express in Node).
- **Entity Framework Core (EF Core)** = the ORM (like Eloquent in Laravel or Prisma in Next.js) — lets you work with the database using C# objects instead of raw SQL.
- Typical structure: **Controllers** (handle requests) → **Services** (business logic) → **Models/Entities** (data) → **DbContext** (database connection).
- Projects are usually built and run with the `dotnet` CLI (`dotnet new webapi`, `dotnet run`).

A Tiny Example to Read & Be Able to Explain (a minimal Web API "Student" endpoint)

```
csharp
```

```
// Program.cs (ASP.NET Core minimal API style)
var builder = WebApplication.CreateBuilder(args);
builder.Services.AddControllers();
var app = builder.Build();
app.MapControllers();
app.Run();

// Models/Student.cs
public class Student
{
    public int Id { get; set; }
    public string Name { get; set; }
    public string Department { get; set; }
}

// Controllers/StudentController.cs
[ApiController]
[Route("api/[controller]")]
public class StudentController : ControllerBase
{
    private static List<Student> students = new();

    [HttpGet]
    public IActionResult GetAll() => Ok(students);

    [HttpPost]
    public IActionResult Add(Student s)
    {
        students.Add(s);
        return Ok(s);
    }
}
```

How to talk about this in the interview:

"This is a simple ASP.NET Core Web API — a `StudentController` that exposes GET and POST endpoints, very similar in structure to a Laravel controller or an Express route. I understand the pattern well because it maps to what I already do in Laravel and Next.js — I'd just need to get fluent in C# syntax and the .NET tooling."

If you have a few spare hours before the interview, you could install the .NET SDK and literally run this once (`dotnet new webapi`), paste a controller, (`dotnet run`), hit it with Postman) — being able to say *"I actually tried it out yesterday"* is a strong, memorable

answer. But don't stress if there's no time — the honest "I'm learning it, here's why, here's how the concepts transfer" answer is enough.

8. Quick Networking/IT Basics Refresher (in case they test general IT knowledge)

- **IP Address:** unique identifier for a device on a network.
 - **DNS:** translates domain names (google.com) into IP addresses.
 - **DHCP:** automatically assigns IP addresses to devices on a network.
 - **LAN vs WAN:** LAN = local network (one building/campus); WAN = wide network (internet, multiple sites).
 - **Firewall:** filters incoming/outgoing traffic to block unauthorized access.
 - **Backup strategy:** regular scheduled backups (daily/weekly), stored off-site or in cloud, tested restores.
 - **Biometric/attendance systems, CCTV, campus Wi-Fi** — mention you're comfortable coordinating with vendors for these even if you haven't built one yourself.
-

9. Smart Questions to Ask the Panel at the End

Always have 1-2 ready — it shows genuine interest:

- "What systems or tools does the Institute currently rely on that I'd be responsible for maintaining or improving?"
 - "Is there a current IT team I'd be working with, or would I be building processes from scratch?"
 - "What would success look like in this role in the first 6 months?"
-

10. Final Two-Day Checklist

- ☐ Print CV, cover letter, CNIC copy, degree/transcript, and photo (as listed in your application)
- ☐ Iron formal clothes — plain, conservative, dark/neutral colors; polished shoes
- ☐ Review this guide once fully, then just skim Sections 3-7 the morning of
- ☐ (Optional but high-impact) Spend 1-2 hours installing .NET SDK and running the sample above once
- ☐ Prepare 2 questions to ask (Section 9)

- ☐ Arrive 20-30 minutes early to Wah Medical College, The Mall, Wah Cantt
 - ☐ Phone on silent, greet respectfully, wait to be seated, maintain calm and confident tone throughout
-

One quick note: today's date is **July 17, 2026** — you mentioned the interview is "in two days, on 16 July," which would actually be *yesterday*. Please double check the exact date/time with WMC so you don't miss it or over/under-prepare on timing — everything else in this guide holds regardless of the exact day.

Good luck, Ahtesham — you have a genuinely strong, hands-on CV for this role. Walk in confident.